Policy Chapters

The policy section is a key component of the OCP. It includes goals, objectives, and policy actions. Together, they set priorities and help guide land use decisions.

Key elements of the policy section

- Consists of eight chapters, including housing, economy, transportation, and community infrastructure.
- Each chapter has an overarching goal, multiple objectives and detailed policy actions.
- Goals are the broad ideas about what the City wants to achieve in the future.
- Objectives identify in more detail the key priorities to help reach each goal.
- Policy actions include both policies and actions. The policies provide guidelines for decision-making. The actions are the specific things the City will do to meet each objective.

Housing

Goal: Housing for All – Facilitate the provision of affordable, non-market, rental and ownership housing to meet the needs of Surrey's residents over the next 20 years.

Objectives

- Accelerate the delivery of housing.
- Ensure a diversity of housing forms, tenures, and affordability levels throughout the City.
- Increase the supply of purpose-built rental housing.
- Protect tenants and vulnerable households.
- Increase supply of non-market housing.

Objective 1: Accelerate the delivery of housing.

Policy Actions

H.1 Ensure that zoning, land supply, and permitted densities align with the 20-year housing need identified in the latest Housing Needs Report.

H.2 Fast-track housing development approvals with a focus on affordable and higher density housing close to major transit network.

H.3 Continually ensure OCP designations, housing policies, and zoning regulations align with current and emerging market conditions.

H.4 Streamline and expedite the development process by:

a. Considering additional delegation of authority to City approving officers;

b. Expediting the application review process;

c. Expanding the use of professional reliance; and/or

d. Using technology and artificial intelligence.

H.5 Simplify the building process by expanding the use of:

a. Standardized housing designs;

b. Prefabricated dwelling units; and/or

c. Other simplified and easily replicated residential building forms.

H.6 Incentivize rental and non-market housing by exploring options such as:

a. Reducing parking requirements;

b. Waiving development fees and charges;

c. Contributing land; and/or

d. Other financial or non-financial incentives.

Objective 2: Ensure a diversity of housing forms, tenures, and affordability levels throughout the City.

Policy Actions

H.7 Expand permissions for small scale multi-unit housing, including secondary suites, coach houses, garden suites, duplexes, triplexes, houseplexes, and townhouses.

H.8 Incentivize and consider requiring family friendly and multi-generational units with two or more bedrooms in new multi-unit buildings in City Centre, Town Centres, and other growth areas.

H.9 Establish an up-to-date inventory of accessible and adaptable units.

H.10 Broaden the availability of adaptable housing units and explore minimum accessible unit requirements in new developments.

H.11 Encourage and permit student housing on the campuses of post-secondary educational institutions.

Objective 3: Increase the supply of purpose-built rental housing.

Policy Actions

H.12 Target a healthy vacancy rate of approximately 4 percent for purpose-built rental housing citywide.

H.13 Maintain or increase the number of rental units and bedrooms when existing purpose-built rental housing sites are redeveloped.

H.14 Advocate to senior governments for policy and taxation changes that will encourage the construction of purpose-built rental apartments.

H.15 Explore tools and/or mechanisms to support the development of new purpose-built rental housing, including:

a. Expediting applications;

b. Reducing parking requirements;

c. Waiving development fees and charges; and/or

d. Financial or non-financial incentives.

Objective 4: Protect tenants and vulnerable households.

Policy Actions

H.16 Conversion of primary rental apartment buildings or co-operative housing into stratified condominiums will only be permitted when city-wide vacancy rates are above 4%.

H.17 Redevelopment of primary rental sites will only be permitted when tenants are informed, assisted, and compensated.

H.18 Redevelopment of existing manufactured home sites will only be permitted when residents are informed, assisted, and compensated.

H.19 Regularly review and update the City's bylaws and policies in relation to rental housing redevelopment, manufactured home park redevelopment, and tenant protection.

H.20 Review and update the City's bylaw in relation to standards of rental building maintenance.

Objective 5: Increase the supply of non-market housing.

Policy Actions

H.21 Support non-market housing projects in all communities and encourage them in locations:

a. With access to transit routes;

b. In defined TOAs;

c. In the City Centre and Town Centres; and

H.22 With access to shopping, civic facilities and other services and amenities.

H.23 Prioritize Indigenous-led non-market housing projects.

H.24 Incentivize and/or require the delivery of non-market rental housing through "as-of-right" zoning, inclusionary zoning, and density benefits.

H.25 Support the development of non-market housing by:

a. Expediting applications;

b. Reducing parking requirements;

c. Waiving development fees and charges;

d. Contributing land; and/or

e. Providing other-incentives.

H.26 Develop a land acquisition and funding strategy to acquire sites for non-market housing.

H.27 Provide opportunities for the co-location of non-market housing with new civic facilities, such as recreation centres, libraries, and fire halls.

H.28 Partner with BC Housing, provincial and Federal agencies, non-profit organizations, and private developers to provide non-market housing that will meet the current and future needs of residents.

Economy

Goal: Develop a robust, resilient, and sustainable economy that allows Surrey to thrive.

Objectives:

- Reinforce City Centre as the business, commercial, institutional, and cultural heart of the City.
- Protect and optimize Industrial and Employment designated lands.
- Encourage economic diversification throughout the City.

Objective 1: Reinforce City Centre as the business, commercial, institutional, and cultural heart of the City.

Policy Actions

E.1 Designate sufficient land in City Centre to accommodate long-term office space demand.

E.2 Support the growth of major institutions in City Centre including universities and hospitals.

E.3 Establish a vibrant entertainment district that draws visitors from throughout the region and explore tools to incentivize entertainment and hospitality businesses.

E.4 Encourage the development of conference facilities in City Centre.

E.5 Support the clustering of arts and culture facilities and organizations within City Centre.

E.6 Locate high density residential development in City Centre to support businesses and provide housing nearby for the workforce.

E.7 Invest in high-quality public spaces that support City Centre's role as the principal gathering place in the city and ensure public spaces are designed for year-round use and a variety of events and activities.

E.8 Advocate for convenient transit access to City Centre from all parts of Surrey and the wider region.

E.9 Foster partnerships between government, local businesses, cultural organizations, and developers to promote the vibrancy of City Centre.

Objective 2: Protect and optimize Industrial and Employment designated lands.

Policy Actions

E.10 Encourage the intensification of industrial and employment lands by:

a. Allowing multi-storey development;

b. Diversifying employment uses; and

c. Supporting higher intensity activities, such as high-tech, research and development, and light manufacturing.

E.11 Discourage the conversion of Industrial or Employment designated lands to non-employment uses, especially lands that are accessible by water or rail.

E.12 Ensure commercial and retail uses on industrial lands are accessory and subordinate to a principal industrial use or provide services and amenities to industrial workers.

E.13 Maintain an inventory of the use and availability of industrial land in conjunction with Metro Vancouver.

E.14 Work with the Vancouver Fraser Port Authority to limit conflict and support efficient operations.

Objective 3: Encourage economic diversification throughout the City.

Policy Actions

E.15 Encourage and support the location of local serving office, commercial, and service space in Town Centres and mixed-use neighbourhood centres, particularly near transit and active transportation networks.

E.16 Support the development of conference, sports, entertainment, and cultural venues in key locations such as Cloverdale Fairgrounds and the South Westminster waterfront, in addition to those in City Centre.

E.17 Make City-owned land available to attract strategic private sector investment and provide opportunities for unique community focused enterprises.

E.18 Encourage private sector investment through:

a. Development incentive programs;

b. The creation of economic investment zones; and

c. Streamlined zoning, servicing, and permitting processes.

E.19 Support agricultural diversification, including agri-tourism, agri-tech, and agri-food businesses.

E.20 Facilitate the location of cultural and entertainment uses with complementary services in commercial and retail areas.

E.21 Continue to work with Business Improvement Areas, Chambers of Commerce, and Boards of Trade to grow local businesses.

Transportation

Goal: Safe, efficient, and connected transportation that provides mobility choices for all.

Objectives:

- Deliver a safe, efficient, and accessible transportation network.
- Provide greater transportation choice.
- Make public transit convenient.
- Reduce traffic congestion.

Objective 1: Deliver a safe, efficient, and accessible transportation network.

Policy Actions

T.1 Ensure the City's transportation design criteria guide the development of a network that:

a. Prioritizes the movement of people efficiently;

b. Aligns with current industry standards;

c. Prioritizes road safety; and

d. Is practical to build and maintain.

T.2 Promote a robust street network that:

a. Supports multi-modal transportation options/ multiple travel options;

b. Connects public spaces; and

c. Discourages cul-de-sacs and large blocks.

T.3 Require new developments to provide multi-modal transportation infrastructure as specified by City transportation design criteria to serve the site and connect seamlessly with the surrounding transportation network.

T.4 Support the use of rear lanes to:

a. Provide private property vehicle access;

b. Limit driveways fronting streets; and

c. Enhance safety and walkability.

T.5 Continually update the 10-Year Servicing Plan with transportation projects consistent with a transportation system that is efficient, equitable, safe, and sustainable.

Objective 2: Provide greater transportation choice.

Policy Actions

T.6 Improve pedestrian safety and comfort through design strategies, including:

a. Ensuring all new and retrofitted sidewalks are built to current standards as they pertain to landscaping, green infrastructure, lighting, and public art;

b. Increasing mid-block crossing opportunities where appropriate;

c. Expanding crosswalks where warranted; and

d. managing vehicle speeds and volumes on local roads and in neighbourhoods.

T.7 Establish and complete a core cycling network that is connected and safe.

T.8 Locate bicycle and micromobility-supportive facilities at or near rapid transit stations, bus exchanges, and at appropriate locations along transit corridors.

T.9 Implement the Sidewalk Action Plan that prioritizes safe pedestrian access to schools, bus stops and rapid transit stations, parks, and daily needs such as grocery stores.

Objective 3: Make public transit convenient.

Policy Actions

T.10 Support the development of Surrey City Centre as the major transit hub for the South of Fraser region.

T.11 Support the planning and development of a grid-based transit network in Surrey that connects all Town Centres and neighbouring communities in all land use plans and new developments.

T.12 Identify and incorporate transit priority measures/improvements in road and intersection projects.

T.13 Collaborate and/or partner with TransLink to ensure transit infrastructure and stations are human-scaled, fully accessible, highly visible, well connected to the street network, and incorporate public art.

T.14 Advocate, at all levels of government, for increased transit service for Surrey.

T.15 Collaborate with TransLink, other levels of government, and neighbouring jurisdictions to expand rapid transit consistent with Transport 2050 and the Surrey Transit Strategy.

T.16 Ensure Surrey residents have safe and comfortable access to public transit by:

a. Completing the sidewalk network within 400m of bus stops, where appropriate;

b. Expanding the availability of bus shelters; and

c. Ensuring all bus stops are accessible.

T.17 Work with TransLink to improve transit service in Surrey, including:

a. Expanding the Rapid Transit and Frequent Transit Network;

b. Expanding local bus service;

c. Implementing transit priority measures; and

d. Improving the safety, convenience, attractiveness, and accessibility of transit at stations, stops, and exchanges.

Objective 4: Reduce traffic congestion.

Policy Actions

T.18 Identify and eliminate critical road network gaps and points of congestion through strategic network, road, and intersection improvement projects.

T.19 Facilitate consistent flows of traffic by:

a. Restricting the number of driveways that directly access arterial roads along high-volume streets; and

b. Exploring traffic control options that improve safety and maintain the flow of traffic.

T.20 Establish a curb space access strategy to:

a. Reduce congestion;

b. Optimize on-street parking demand;

c. Support goods movement; and

d. Improve safety.

T.21 Facilitate efficient goods movement through the use of Designated Truck Routes.

T.22 Implement strategies to mitigate traffic congestion, including, but not limited to, widening existing roads, adding new roads, and improving key intersections.

T.23 Complete and maintain a grid road pattern consisting of arterial and major collector roads linking all areas of Surrey consistent with the Surrey Road Classification Map.

T.24 Formalize a clear and consistent approach to delivering Transportation Demand Management measures.

T.25 Collaborate with senior levels of government and TransLink to improve efficiencies along goods movement corridors, including those accessing port facilities, international border crossings, rail lines, and major river crossings.

Utility Infrastructure

Goal: Develop resilient grey and green utility infrastructure that is aligned with community growth.

Objectives:

- Ensure utilities keep pace with growth.
- Maintain healthy and sustainable water and sanitary infrastructure.
- Develop resilient and integrated stormwater infrastructure.
- Reduce solid waste and promote its diversion.
- Increase energy independence, resilience, and sustainability.

Objective 1: Ensure utilities keep pace with growth.

Policy Actions

U.1 Encourage the development of more compact and efficient land uses and servicing systems, using existing infrastructure systems efficiently through infill and intensification to minimize the costs of new utility infrastructure.

U.2 Recognize that neighbourhoods will continue to have different levels of service for streetlights, sidewalks, drainage, and parks and that retrofitting will be addressed first in high priority areas and areas experiencing significant redevelopment, in the context of neighbourhood equity. New development will be required to meet current standards or standards specified within secondary plans.

U.3 Site and design new telecommunications equipment, in consultation with neighbourhood residents, using the following standards:

a. Locate new equipment on existing structures (e.g. building rooftops and utility poles);

b. Design towers and ancillary equipment to fit the surroundings and to minimize visual impact on surrounding properties;

c. Landscape the surroundings of towers and ancillary equipment as a visual buffer; and

d. Minimize the physical and visual appearance of towers and equipment.

U.4 Regularly update a 10-year Engineering Servicing Plan to identify the infrastructure works and services necessary to meet the needs of the City's existing population and to support growth.

U.5 Work with senior levels of government and private partners to deliver major infrastructure improvements, including transportation, communication, and utility infrastructure.

Objective 2: Maintain healthy and sustainable water and sanitary infrastructure.

Policy Actions

U.6 Require developers to pay for the water and sanitary upgrades needed to support their new development.

U.7 Encourage the reduction, reuse, and recycling of domestic water through appropriate site landscaping and building design technology.

U.8 Provide, operate, and maintain the City's water distribution system to ensure reliability and sustainability of water services to residents and in support of the goals and objectives of Metro Vancouver's Drinking Water Management Plan.

U.9 Maintain drinking water quality in the water distribution system through:

a. Enforcement of annual testing of existing backflow preventers; and

b. Installation of backflow preventers for all new or redeveloped properties in the City.

U.10 Provide, operate, and maintain the City's sanitary sewer system to ensure reliability and sustainability of sanitary sewer services to residents and in support of the goals and objectives of Metro Vancouver's Liquid Waste Management Plan.

U.11 Regularly inspect Surrey's sanitary sewer system to ensure it:

a. Can provide reliable service for existing and new development;

b. Is being maintained and replaced in a planned approach; and

c. Is reducing the risk of rainwater and groundwater entering the sanitary sewer system.

Objective 3: Develop resilient and integrated stormwater infrastructure.

Policy Actions

U.12 Require developers to pay for stormwater extensions, flow control and water quality treatment facilities, and system upgrades needed to support their new development

U.13 Plan and implement resilient and effective on- and off- site stormwater management practices and facilities (e.g. on-site detention and infiltration, erosion control, rain gardens, etc.) that support development and meet the water quality and biodiversity needs of the watershed.

U.14 Maintain and update Integrated Watershed Management Plans for each watershed catchment to ensure infrastructure is addressing the impacts of land use and development and not harming natural assets.

U.15 Provide, operate, and maintain the City's stormwater drainage system in support of the goals and objectives of Metro Vancouver's Liquid Waste Management Plan.

U.16 Where appropriate, integrate stormwater management facilities into parkland in a functional and attractive manner while simultaneously retaining and/or enhancing natural assets.

Objective 4: Reduce solid waste and promote its diversion.

Policy Actions

U.17 Promote waste reduction and diversion through recycling programs, organic waste collection, curbside pick-up restrictions, and public education.

U.18 Maximize the use and benefit of the Surrey green waste recycling and biofuel facility.

U.19 Provide solid waste services in Surrey consistent with the region's approach to solid waste management.

U.20 Explore opportunities to reduce demolition and construction waste through diversion.

Objective 5: Increase energy independence, resilience, and sustainability.

Policy Actions

U.21 Provide thermal energy to new buildings through financially sustainable District Energy Systems.

U.22 Focus the initial development of Surrey's District Energy System within the City Centre and develop future systems in Town Centres and along high-density corridors, where feasible.

U.23 Develop a decarbonization plan for the District Energy System.

U.24 Work with BC Hydro and other utility companies to coordinate planning and development of electricity and utility infrastructure.

Natural Assets, Biodiversity & Green Infrastructure

Goal: Foster resilient natural assets, biodiversity, and green infrastructure across the city.

Objectives:

- Design a city where biodiversity can flourish.
- Value and enhance natural assets.
- Protect and address gaps in the tree canopy.

Objective 1: Design a city where biodiversity can flourish.

Policy Actions

N.1 Support a city and regionally connected network of natural areas by preserving and restoring riparian areas and watercourses and linking them with upland natural areas.

N.2 Development should be planned and designed to avoid, minimize, and where unavoidable, mitigate adverse impacts on wildlife habitat and riparian areas.

N.3 Facilitate the protection of the Biodiversity Conservation Strategy's Green Infrastructure Network and regularly review and adapt policies to ensure its successful implementation.

N.4 Target ecologically significant lands when protecting land in the Green Infrastructure Network.

N.5 Integrate wildlife crossing mitigation considerations into capital projects in keeping with the Biodiversity Conservation Strategy.

N.6 Increase biodiversity values through implementation of the City's Biodiversity Design Guidelines, development permitting, public education, and relevant bylaws.

N.7 Use programming and resources to raise public awareness of ecosystem services and the value of nature.

N.8 Provide property owners with guidance on retaining habitat and native plant communities.

N.9 Pursue opportunities to partner with other levels of government, neighbouring jurisdictions, private land interests, and community groups to acquire and/or protect lands through other means, in such areas as:

a. Sensitive ecosystems;

b. Critical habitat for species at risk;

c. Forested escarpments along the Fraser River; and

d. Forested flood plans in the agricultural lowlands.

Objective 2: Value and enhance natural assets.

Policy Actions

N.10 Use legislative and policy tools (such as Sensitive Ecosystem Development Permits) to help conserve, enhance, and mitigate impacts on aquatic areas, riparian corridors, and the Green Infrastructure Network.

N.11 Complete a citywide natural asset inventory.

N.12 Use green infrastructure approaches to design drainage systems in a manner that more closely reflect pre-development conditions and natural drainage patterns.

N.13 Protect vulnerable aquifers and other shared groundwater resources in collaboration with other levels of government, neighbouring jurisdictions, and affected interest holders.

Objective 3: Protect and address gaps in the tree canopy.

Policy Actions

N.14 Implement Surrey's Urban Forest Management Strategy by:

a. Ensuring adequate space and growing medium is provided;

b. Protecting and retaining mature forest stands, significant trees, and other important natural features;

c. Maximizing shade tree coverage on City lands and right-of-ways; and

d. Ensuring equitable tree canopy coverage across the city.

N.15 Regularly review and update Surrey's Tree Protection Bylaw to ensure current best practices are applied in tree protection and retention.

Community Infrastructure

Goal: Develop community infrastructure and facilities throughout the city to meet the needs of a diverse and growing population.

Objectives:

- Shape neighbourhoods and communities in a manner that fosters social connection, livability, and safety.
- Provide a public space network that is accessible, centrally located, and well connected.
- Establish and grow arts and culture as part of the physical and social make-up of the City.
- Advance a heritage program that is inclusive and equitable.
- Advocate for and help guide the provision of non-municipal community facilities and services.

Objective 1: Shape neighbourhoods and communities in a manner that fosters social connection, livability, and safety.

Policy Actions

CI.1 Plan for and locate new civic recreational, cultural, heritage, and library facilities in Town Centres, close to transit, prioritizing growing and under-served areas of the city.

CI.2 Co-locate public facilities, such as recreation facilities, and libraries, where possible.

CI.3 Ensure multi-family, mixed use, commercial, and institutional development proposals support social connection, universal accessibility, and safety by:

a. Requiring compatibility of scale, massing, and architecture with adjacent sites;

b. Designing for safety and comfort;

c. Integrating, connecting, and maximizing access for all users;

d. Promoting vibrant, active, and pedestrian friendly public and private environments;

e. Designing for flexibility of uses and resiliency in changing contexts; and

f. Responding appropriately to environmental features to create a "Sense of Place".

CI.4 Use the Form & Character Development Guidelines to help foster and establish a distinct character for each Town Centre and City Centre, including:

a. Promoting, preserving, and enhancing unique characteristics such as architectural styles, built and natural heritage, cultural heritage, social gathering spaces, places of worship, landmark buildings, landscapes, or signs;

b. Creating distinctive gateways and identification signs at main entrances;

c. Establishing a defining design style by coordinating the use of signs, banners, public art, paving materials and patterns, street trees, street lights, and site furnishings; and

d. Emphasizing a high standard of urban, landscaping, and architectural design.

Objective 2: Provide a public space network that is accessible, centrally located, and well connected.

Policy Actions

CI.5 Acquire parkland based on the following priorities:

a. Working towards providing 4.2 ha of parkland per 1,000 residents citywide and locating 1 park within 500 m of all residents that can be accessed without crossing an arterial road;

b. Increasing access in neighbourhoods with a limited supply of parkland or publicly accessible open spaces;

c. Protecting, preserving, and restoring natural areas and habitat corridors consistent with the recommendations of the Biodiversity Conservation Strategy and Green Infrastructure Network;

d. Increasing public waterfront access rights to shorelines and beaches; and

e. Securing/acquiring larger land holdings for recreation and conservation.

CI.6 Expand Surrey's open space, trail, and waterways network by:

a. Using green corridors, walkways, and greenways to connect parks, open spaces, natural areas, public spaces, and plazas; and

b. Collaborating with Metro Vancouver and neighbouring municipalities to connect to neighbouring municipal and regional parks on Surrey's border that are identified in Metro Vancouver's Regional Green Infrastructure Network.

CI.7 Work with provincial and federal government to secure waterfront access rights to shorelines and beaches.

CI.8 Create universally accessible public spaces by:

a. Locating in Town Centres and close to transit; and

b. Designing grades, surface materials, and signage to meet the needs of all users.

CI.9 Incorporate Crime Prevention through Environmental Design principles into the planning and development of parks, open spaces, plazas, and greenways.

Objective 3: Establish and grow arts and culture as part of the physical and social make-up of the City.

Policy Actions

CI.10 Plan for and locate new arts and culture facilities in the art and culture district in the City Centre and the Cultural Corridor along King George Boulevard, as well as elsewhere in the City.

CI.11 Secure new cultural spaces by pursuing senior government funding, land donations, contributions through site development, private donations, and regulation changes, as appropriate.

CI.12 Facilitate local creative hubs in Town Centres that offer affordable studio, rehearsal, and production spaces for artists and cultural workers.

CI.13 Collaborate with Indigenous communities to reflect Indigenous culture in destination spaces (high-profile public areas like plazas, parks, libraries, transit hubs, and cultural facilities) through art, language, and storytelling.

CI.14 Establish participatory design processes for new cultural and public spaces in City Centre and Town Centres, involving local artists, cultural groups, and residents.

CI.15 Support the locating of public art installations in highly visible locations in the city through land use planning and development application review processes.

Objective 4: Advance a heritage program that is inclusive and equitable.

Policy Actions

CI.16 Ensure additions to the Heritage Register are selected based on aesthetic, historic, scientific, cultural, social, spiritual, inclusive, and equitable heritage values.

CI.17 Inform Indigenous cultural heritage planning and decision making through Indigenous knowledge, experiences, and perspectives.

CI.18 Ensure heritage design and landscape guidelines inform the development process for projects in heritage character areas or abutting heritage streets.

CI.19 Support the adaptive reuse of heritage buildings in Town Centres for arts, culture, and community uses.

CI.20 Expand the Form & Character Development Guidelines to include general and area specific heritage character guidelines.

CI.21 Incentivize the protection of heritage buildings, structures, and features through:

a. Explore streamlining the application process and fee structure;

b. Restoration and maintenance grants;

c. Permissive property tax exemption; and

d. Zoning relaxations.

Objective 5: Advocate for and help guide the provision of non-municipal community facilities and services.

Policy Actions

CI.22 Work with the Surrey School District and the provincial government to locate new public schools in emerging and rapidly growing neighborhoods.

CI.23 Support innovative school models, including urban schools in mixed use developments close to transit.

CI.24 Support the location of new and the expansion of existing post-secondary institutions close to transit.

CI.25 Plan for health services and medically supportive uses around existing facilities (Surrey Memorial Hospital and Peace Arch Hospital) and future facilities (Cloverdale Hospital).

CI.26 Work with the Fraser Health Authority, health providers, non-profits, and the provincial government to expand existing facilities and to plan for and strategically locate new facilities including mental health, substance use treatment, complex care, and other specialized health needs facilities.

CI.27 Support the development or expansion of childcare centres by ensuring regulations, zoning, and policies permit on-site childcare centres:

a. On City properties or in conjunction with civic buildings;

b. In commercial, mixed-use, and multi-family developments; and

c. In existing commercial developments that are retrofitted.

Climate, Natural Hazards & Emergency Preparedness

Goal: Become a zero carbon city that is prepared for climate impacts and other emergencies.

Objectives:

- Embed climate action into city planning and operations.
- Reduce GHG emissions and increase climate resilience across all sectors.
- Reduce the vulnerability of development and the community to hazards.

Objective 1: Embed climate action into city planning and operations.

Policy Actions

CH.1 Explore evaluation tools and processes to integrate climate commitments and considerations into city decision-making on policies.

CH.2 Support the transition to zero-carbon and resilient city assets with the goal to work towards absolute zero corporate GHG emissions before 2050.

CH.3 Update climate risk and vulnerability assessments when appropriate to incorporate updated climate projections into operations, asset management, and long-term planning.

CH.4 Deliver education campaigns to increase public awareness and understanding of city climate action priorities in policies, land use planning, and growth decisions.

Objective 2: Reduce GHG emissions and increase climate resilience across all sectors.

Policy Actions

CH.5 Partner with senior governments, industries, organizations, businesses, and residents to work towards phasing out fossil fuel use with the goal of achieving a 45% reduction in GHG emissions below 2010 levels by 2030 and net zero emissions before 2050.

CH.6 Update land use plans and the Zoning Bylaw regularly to incorporate 15-minute neighbourhood design principles.

CH.7 Support the advancement to zero-carbon energy in all buildings by:

a. Advocating to utilities and the province for affordable zero-carbon energy;

b. Collaborating with BC Hydro to enable provision of sufficient electrical supply; and

c. Developing a plan to transition Surrey City Energy to zero-carbon by 2050. (See also *Utilities*)

CH.8 Support the phase out of operational greenhouse gas emissions and increase energy efficiency for all new buildings through Energy Step Code and Zero Carbon Step Code requirements.

CH.9 Encourage building design features that conserve energy and water, reduce GHG emissions, and increase resilience through the Form and Character Development Permit Guidelines and other design guidance.

CH.10 Explore opportunities to incentivize developments that exceed minimum regulatory requirements for energy efficiency and zero-carbon performance.

CH.11 Encourage construction practices and technologies that reduce embodied carbon and improve climate resilience of new buildings.

CH.12 Accelerate affordable zero-carbon resilience retrofits of existing buildings by:

a. Advocating to senior levels of government for regulations, funding, and supportive programs; and

b. Developing a comprehensive existing building strategy.

CH.13 Ensure transportation practices, policies, standards, and capital plans that prioritize walking, cycling and public transit, including through the integration of green infrastructure (e.g. street trees or raingardens) alongside active transportation infrastructure. (See also *Transportation*)

CH.14 Support the transition to zero and low emission vehicles by increasing access to electric vehicle charging infrastructure in underground parking areas of new multifamily buildings.

CH.15 Protect, connect and restore ecosystems and encourage opportunities for negative emissions by incorporating green infrastructure in city projects, managing natural assets for climate resilience, and exploring opportunities for improved carbon sequestration in natural areas.

CH.16 Work toward zero-waste and a circular economy through regional collaboration, programs, and services.

Objective 3: Reduce the vulnerability of development and the community to hazards.

Policy Actions

CH.17 Manage the risks posed by steep or unstable slopes and coastal or riverine flooding through implementation of the Hazard Lands Development Permit Area and its associated guidelines.

CH.18 Collaborate with senior levels of government and key stakeholders regarding floodplain management, dyking standards, and coastal flood strategies for vulnerable areas.

CH.19 Integrate emergency preparedness management plan considerations into land use planning to mitigate and prepare for risks through an understanding of local hazards and their potential impacts.

CH.20 Mitigate earthquake-related risks and impacts by:

a. Evaluating seismic and liquefaction risk to identify vulnerable areas; and

b. Integrating hazard mapping into land use planning and updating relevant policies and guidelines for new construction.

CH.21 Increase capacity to respond to extreme weather events and other emergencies by working with partners to support resilience hubs and integrate cooling, clean air, and warming resources in key areas of the city.

Agriculture & Food Systems

Goal: A thriving agricultural economy and healthy local food systems.

Objectives:

- Protect and enhance Surrey's agricultural land base.
- Foster growth and investment in Surrey's agricultural and food sectors.
- Enhance Surrey's local food system and improve access to food for all residents.

Objective 1: Protect and enhance Surrey's agricultural land base.

Policy Actions

AF.1 Maintain the integrity of Surrey's Agricultural Land Reserve (ALR) by:

a. Preserving the current extent of the ALR boundary;

b. Discouraging non-farm uses in the ALR;

c. Avoiding subdivision of ALR lands and adhering to minimum lot sizes prescribed by the City of Surrey Zoning Bylaw;

d. Requiring inclusion of 2 ha of equal or better farmland into the ALR within Surrey for every 1 ha excluded; and

e. Minimizing parcel fragmentation when constructing roads, utility corridors, and greenways.

AF.2 Maximize agricultural land for farm uses by:

a. Preserving lands with prime agricultural soil for soil-based agriculture;

b. Recommending non-soil based agricultural uses and structures on less productive soil through the application review process; and

c. Clustering residential buildings and structure close to roads.

AF.3 Promote environmental stewardship on agricultural lands by:

a. Encouraging the province's Environmental Farm Plan Program;

b. Continuing regenerative agricultural practices on city parkland in the ALR; and

c. Working with farmers to implement the city's Green Infrastructure Network and enhance wildlife habitat on agricultural lands, where appropriate.

AF.4 Ensure agriculture and agriculture supportive zones, policies and guidelines remain current and consistent with provincial and federal requirements by:

a. Regularly updating agricultural zones, definitions, and regulations in the Zoning Bylaw;

b. Maintaining Farm Protection Guidelines; and

c. Responding to changes in Agricultural Land Commission and provincial Ministry of Agriculture regulations.

AF.5 Manage lowland agricultural drainage in alignment with provincial agreements and strategic flood control plans.

AF.6 Ensure access to water on ALR lands by:

a. Working with Metro Vancouver to provide potable water to farm residences and agri-business; and

b. Working with the provincial government to provide licensing for agricultural irrigation.

AF.7 Maintain farm vehicle travel routes in Surrey's transportation network to ensure fast and reliable access between farms and markets.

AF.8 Implement the City's Development Permit Guidelines for Farming Protection to minimize conflicts and nuisance complaints along the urban-agricultural edge.

Objective 2: Foster growth and investment in Surrey's agricultural and food sectors.

Policy Actions

AF.9 Support agri-food businesses by:

a. Allowing on site-processing, value-added production and direct sales that are proportionate to the agricultural operations on ALR lands; and

b. Allowing food processing, storage and distribution on industrial and employment designated lands.

AF.10 Support new and emerging agri-tourism activities on farms by regularly updating agriculture zoning and policies, in accordance with ALC rules.

AF.11 Ensure policies and zoning are regularly updated to permit existing and emerging agri-tech businesses within the City's industrial and employment designated lands, and on lands in the ALR, in accordance with ALC rules.

AF.12 Establish and maintain an effective channel of communication between the City and the farming community to ensure City led projects, programs, and policies contribute to the growth of the agriculture and food sectors.

AF.13 Support farming cooperatives, incubators and other economic tools and incentives that provide new farmers with access to land.

Objective 3: Enhance Surrey's local food system and improve access to food for all residents.

Policy Actions

AF.14 Encourage food providers such as grocers, restaurants and community kitchens to locate in established urban residential neighbourhoods by regularly updating land use policies and zoning regulations to remove barriers that food providers may face in locating in these areas.

AF.15 Expand opportunities for residents to participate in the production of local, healthy and culturally specific food by:

a. Encouraging new developments to provide opportunities for on-site food production, such as garden plots and edible landscapes, as part of the residential amenity space.

b. Permit temporary community gardens on under-utilized or vacant privately-owned land.

AF.16 Support the development of community gardens in neighbourhood parks through partnerships with non-profit groups, neighbourhood associations, and other interested parties.

AF.17 Work with Fraser Health, non-governmental and non-profit organizations that are addressing food security by sharing data, assisting with program implementation and supporting the creation of new spaces for food production, education, and access.